Simulated motor - electrical and thermal troubleshooting

FICTIONAL TRAINING MANUAL - NOT A MANUFACTURER DOCUMENT

Applicability: Prototype motor MTR-001, asset simulation-01, Simulator.html and the Python server model. These fictional instructions apply only to virtual controls. They are not approved physical-equipment limits, maintenance specifications, or evidence of a real fault.

READING THE SIGNAL

Channels: temperature in degC; motor current in A; vibration RMS and acceleration X/Y/Z in g; gyroscope X/Y/Z in deg/s. Published rpm is the selected setpoint. Effective rotation is reduced internally for Overload and Stall. Acceleration RMS in g must not be relabeled as velocity in mm/s.

The simulator publishes non-retained MQTT sensor windows. Each window includes min, mean, max and sample count. Waveforms contain the faster model samples; slow dashboard summaries do not prove a harmonic or spectral frequency.

DETECTION AND ILLUSTRATIVE LABELS

Each channel has its own rolling z-score against previous valid values. The default detector warms up over five windows, uses up to twenty baseline values, and flags an absolute score of at least three. A standard-deviation floor prevents division by zero. A statistical deviation does not identify its physical cause.

Illustrative model labels use vibration above 0.15 g or temperature above 60 degC or relative current above 1.35 for WARNING, and vibration above 0.35 g or temperature above 75 degC or relative current above 1.9 for FAULT. Relative current uses the selected-speed healthy-current model. These demonstration labels are independent of the rolling detector and are not approved operating limits.

Normal operation and baseline drift

EXPECTED SIMULATED SIGNATURE

Healthy virtual motor: small shaft-frequency vibration and residual sensor noise. At a selected speed of 1500 rpm, modeled current settles near 1.6 A and the thermal target is 37 degC. Initial temperature is 28 degC and approaches the target gradually. A warming motor can trigger a statistical temperature deviation even with Normal selected.

DISTINGUISHING EVIDENCE

A rolling z-score describes change relative to recent values. It is not a confirmed fault, an ISO vibration classification, or an approved machine limit. Constant high readings can become statistically normal as the baseline adapts.

VIRTUAL TROUBLESHOOTING CHECKS

Select Normal in the simulator and allow the temperature trend to settle.

Compare the selected shaft speed with the recorded speed before interpreting current.

Review the previous valid windows before interpreting a baseline deviation.

RECOVERY AND LIMITATIONS

Compare repeat windows at the same selected speed and severity. Record the warm-up state and retain the initial event as a historical deviation.

Overheating and reduced cooling

EXPECTED SIMULATED SIGNATURE

Overheating raises the thermal target strongly with severity and adds a small shaft-frequency vibration contribution. Current rises modestly because the simplified model associates hot windings with a load increment. Temperature changes gradually rather than jumping immediately when controls change.

DISTINGUISHING EVIDENCE

A sustained thermal rise with modest current change distinguishes Overheating from Overload, Winding short, and Stall, where the current rise is stronger. Temperature alone does not distinguish reduced cooling from every other physical cause.

VIRTUAL TROUBLESHOOTING CHECKS

Compare the temperature slope with current and selected shaft speed.

Reduce simulated overheating severity and observe the delayed thermal response.

Return to Normal and allow the virtual motor to cool before comparing a fresh steady period.

RECOVERY AND LIMITATIONS

The cool-down button resets modeled temperature to 28 degC and can itself create a negative statistical deviation. Label this reset explicitly instead of reporting a new physical cooling fault.

Overload and excess shaft torque

EXPECTED SIMULATED SIGNATURE

Overload raises mean current substantially, adds torque-related ripple, increases heating, and reduces effective modeled rotation by a severity-dependent fraction. At maximum severity the current increment in the model is 1.6 times the selected-speed current term, while effective rotation loses 12 percent of selected speed.

DISTINGUISHING EVIDENCE

Sustained high current with a load-related speed reduction and modest extra shaft vibration supports Overload. It differs from the fixed mains-related hum in Winding short and the near-locked rotor behavior in Stall. The published rpm is the selected setpoint, not a measured tachometer or effective rotor speed.

VIRTUAL TROUBLESHOOTING CHECKS

Compare the current trend with the Normal current at the same selected speed.

Reduce simulated overload severity and verify that mean current falls.

Inspect the simulated rotor motion and thermal trend before returning the fault selector to Normal.

RECOVERY AND LIMITATIONS

Confirm current recovery over repeat windows and allow temperature to settle. A returned statistical NORMAL label alone is insufficient to prove that virtual overload was removed.

Winding short and electrical ripple

EXPECTED SIMULATED SIGNATURE

Winding short raises current and the thermal target, adds a 100 Hz current ripple, and introduces a 100 Hz hum in acceleration X, Y, and Z. The server waveform is sampled at 1 kHz. The three-second dashboard summaries sample state at a slower cadence and cannot establish a spectral frequency by themselves.

DISTINGUISHING EVIDENCE

A fixed-frequency hum together with a strong current rise differentiates this modeled electrical case from smooth rotor imbalance. A temperature rise or a mean current value alone cannot confirm a physical winding short.

VIRTUAL TROUBLESHOOTING CHECKS

Inspect the server simulator waveform for the fixed-frequency current ripple and acceleration hum.

Compare mean current and temperature with Normal at the same selected speed.

Return the fault selector to Normal and verify that the added ripple and hum subside.

RECOVERY AND LIMITATIONS

Keep waveform evidence separate from dashboard window means. This fictional guide contains no insulation-resistance procedure or authorization to test a real energized motor.

Stall and near-locked rotor

EXPECTED SIMULATED SIGNATURE

Stall causes very high current, almost no effective modeled rotation, low residual shaft vibration, and rapid heating. At maximum severity effective speed loses 95 percent of the selected speed, the current increment is 4.5 times the selected-speed current term, and the thermal response time constant is 6 seconds instead of 12 seconds.

DISTINGUISHING EVIDENCE

Very high current with nearly absent motion and relatively little vibration is the important combination. Low vibration does not mean a stalled motor is healthy. The displayed rpm is a control setpoint; it must not be described as actual rotor motion.

VIRTUAL TROUBLESHOOTING CHECKS

Compare high current with the nearly stationary simulated rotor and low vibration.

Pause the simulator to record the virtual stall state and its controls.

Select Normal and resume the simulator to compare current and motion recovery.

RECOVERY AND LIMITATIONS

Observe a falling current after removing the virtual stall. Temperature retains its history unless the explicit cool-down control is used. The guide does not authorize repeated real-motor restart attempts.

ACQUISITION AND STATISTICAL EDGE CASES

MISSING OR STALE READINGS

Check whether the server, MQTT broker and publisher are connected. A paused model, stopped publisher or disconnected broker can leave old points visible. An old point is history and must not be reported as a fresh normal observation. Resume the publisher and wait for a new valid timestamp.

SENSOR ERROR OR DISCONNECTED SENSOR

A sensor error has null features and zero samples. Missing data is not zero current or a cold temperature. Check the sensor status, sample count and unit before interpreting an apparent deviation.

DUPLICATE, OVERLAPPING OR REJECTED WINDOWS

QoS redelivery can repeat a sequence. The backend ignores duplicate or out-of-order identities and rejects overlapping, stale, future-dated or invalid windows. A missing graph point can indicate rejected transport data rather than a mechanical fault. Compare the publisher and backend clocks and review the received sequence.

STARTUP, CONTROL CHANGES AND BASELINE ADAPTATION

Warm-up, RPM changes, a changed fault severity, and the cool-down reset can all create deviations. Sustained abnormal values can enter the rolling baseline and later receive a NORMAL label. Record the selected mode and control changes alongside every anomaly.

STOPPING AND RESTARTING

Setting selected speed to zero drives modeled current toward zero and removes shaft-driven vibration. This intentional shutdown can differ from the previous rolling baseline. A restarted backend rebuilds its history and baseline. Compare like operating conditions and do not invent measurements across a gap.